IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS OF MEASURE F

Measure F is a special tax ordinance placed on the ballot by the Board of Directors of the Ferndale Fire Protection District. As a "special tax," Measure F must be approved by two-thirds of the voters voting in the election, and the funds raised may only be used for the specified purposes in the ordinance, which are "providing ongoing fire protection and emergency response services, including but not limited to fire suppression and prevention; emergency medical and rescue services; hazardous materials response; and the operation, maintenance, and acquisition of firefighting equipment, apparatus, facilities and necessary capital improvements to ensure the safety of the public and firefighting personnel."

Measure F would create a "parcel tax." This means that each taxable parcel is charged a flat annual fee depending on the type and intensity of use, which is broken down into "parcel use categories" and listed in the measure. These range from a vacant lot, which would be charged $5 per year, to a large commercial lodging of over 20 units, which would be charged $600 per year. There is an appeal process by which a property owner can challenge the parcel use category assigned to their property. Measure F also includes a hardship waiver, which allows a tax exemption for property owners who fall within the U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development's definitions of "very low" or "extremely low" income.

As required by state law, Measure F requires the creation of a special fund into which all proceeds will be deposited, and requires an annual report showing "(a) the amount of special tax revenues collected and spent by the District in the previous fiscal year, (b) the status of any project or work authorized to be funded by the proceeds of this tax, and (c) the funds carried over from previous years and to be carried over in future years."

The Measure would repeal any current assessments imposed by the district and replace it with this parcel tax.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of Measure F. If you desire a copy of the ordinance or measure, please call the elections official's office at 707-445-7481 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you.

You may also access the full text of the measure on the county website at the following website address (www.humboldtgov.org/elections).

Argument in Favor of Measure F

Ferndale Fire Protection District has proudly served our community for generations. Whether responding to fires, medical emergencies, traffic collisions, rescues, natural disasters, or other emergencies, our firefighters are committed to protecting the lives, homes, farms, and businesses that make our district a special place to live.

Measure F is about ensuring that commitment continues well into the future.

The District's existing assessment has remained unchanged for nearly 30 years. During that time, the cost of providing fire and emergency medical services has increased dramatically. Fire engines, protective equipment, communications systems, training requirements, fuel, insurance, and emergency response costs have all risen substantially, while the District has worked diligently to stretch every local dollar.

Despite these challenges, Ferndale Fire Protection District has continued investing in the future. The District has worked to maintain and upgrade apparatus, equipment, and facilities to support reliable emergency response. At the same time, our Department and dedicated volunteers have strengthened training, improved response capabilities, and built strong partnerships with neighboring agencies. Together, these efforts reflect a shared commitment to serving our community while recognizing that our ability to sustain this level of service is limited by available funding.

Measure F will provide a stable, locally controlled source of funding through an annual special tax paid by property owners within the District to ensure the District can continue meeting the growing needs of our community. If approved by voters, Measure F would replace the District's existing parcel assessment with a modern funding structure designed to better keep pace with the rising cost of providing services.

Every dollar generated by Measure F stays local and may only be used to support Ferndale Fire Protection District services. Board oversight and annual reporting will ensure these funds are used responsibly and transparently.

By supporting Measure F, you are helping ensure Ferndale Fire Protection District has the resources to continue serving our community when it matters most.

/s/ Rick Nicholson, Fire Chief, Ferndale Volunteer Fire Department
/s/ Jack Smith, Board Chair, Ferndale Fire Protection District
/s/ Dennis DelBiaggio, Local Business Owner, DCI Builders
/s/ Jay Russ, Local Rancher & Timberland Owner